



Spot goes to Pompeii

Boston Dynamics' Spot recently visited the ruins of Pompeii and boy oh boy are the clips cute! <https://digit.in/apr22-35>



0.00003 BTC per litre

Russia is reportedly considering accepting bitcoin for oil and gas payments. <https://digit.in/apr22-36>

Sony WH-XB910N

Stays true to its moniker

The Sony WH-XB910N is the company's newest entrant in the XB lineup equipped with Noise Cancelling abilities. Users who may not want to spend more than 20K on a noise-cancelling pair of cans may find the Sony WH-XB910N appealing since it is priced at 15K. How do these headphones perform and are they worth their price tag? Let's find out.

BUILD AND COMFORT

The WH-XB910N looks simple and plain but that's not necessarily a bad thing. The headphones are also very light, weighing merely 252g. The weight is also evenly distributed. The headphones have an over-ear design with thick, plushy foam ear cups. The underside of the headband is also padded with foam, making these headphones supremely comfortable to wear.

The headphones are very flexible so they should fit large-sized heads too. The headphones can be folded as well, so they are easily portable.

The power and ANC buttons are situated on the side of the left earcup. They're easy to press and have pretty good tactile feedback. At the bottom, you also have a 3.5mm audio jack to listen to music passively. There's also a USB Type-C port for charging. On the right side, you have the touch-sensitive panel on top of the earcup. The controls are simple, intuitive and worked flawlessly during our testing.

FEATURES

The Sony WH-XB910N serves up an array of features present in the Sony WH-1000XM4 at a more affordable price to users. Firstly, the cans come equipped with Active Noise Cancellation and Ambient Sound. Another excellent feature present on these headphones is Sony Headphones Connect app support. The app allows access to a plethora of features and customisations including Sony's AI-based Adaptive



Sound Control, 5-band customisable EQ, 360 Reality Audio setup, Sony's DSEE technology and voice assistant. You can also toggle multipoint connectivity within the app that allows you to connect two devices to the headphones simultaneously.

As for other features, the headphones come with Quick Attention Mode. Placing your palm on top of the right earcup activates ambient sound and turns down media volume, allowing you to have a quick conversation or pay attention to announcements at railway stations or airports.

PERFORMANCE

The Sony WH-XB910N headphones feature 40mm dynamic drivers and support the SBC, AAC and LDAC audio codecs. The headphones are part of Sony's XB (eXtra Bass) lineup and they stay true to that moniker. While not as ridiculously lows-biased as their predecessors – the Sony WH-XB900N – they still favour the lower end of the frequency spectrum. The cans have a warm, V-shaped sonic signature with boosted bass and treble notes. The bass is punchy and dynamic while the mids

are recessed. This sonic signature lends itself well to genres such as pop, rap, EDM and Bollywood and will please bass lovers. However, audiophiles and purists should turn away since the bloated bass can definitely sound muddy at times and hamper the clarity of the already-recessed mids.

As for ANC performance, it isn't as effective as that on the Mark 4s. The same is true for the Sony WH-1000XM4's ambient sound mode as well, so Sony needs to put in some work in this area.

BATTERY LIFE

The Sony WH-XB910N's battery life is nothing short of exemplary. You get 30 hours of wireless playback with ANC turned on and a whopping 50 hours with ANC turned off. In our tests, the headphones managed a playback time of 31 hours

with ANC turned on and the battery levels set at 60 per cent. Not just this, the headphones also support fast charging.

VERDICT

An affordable alternative to the Sony WH-1000XM4 and a bass lover's dream, the Sony WH-XB910N has a lot going for it. Not only do you get ANC, app support, and multipoint connection support, but you also get a solid, robust build and excellent battery life. However, the ANC performance is not close to Sony's flagship headsets, so keep that in mind. The sound signature is quite bass-forward though. There are options in the market at a similar price range with a more balanced sound signature from Sennheiser and Jabra.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: Approx. 252g | HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, dynamic | DRIVER SIZE: 40mm | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz - 20kHz | CORD LENGTH: 1.2m | WEARING STYLE: Over-ear | DSEE: Yes | PASSIVE OPERATION: Yes | BATTERY LIFE: 30 hours (NC on), 50 hours (NC off) | BATTERY CHARGE TIME: Approx. 3.5 hours | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | RANGE: 10m | SUPPORTED AUDIO CODECS: SBC, AAC, LDAC

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BUILD	78
FEATURES	84
PERFORMANCE.....	64
VALUE.....	70